

Impact Low · Difficulty Medium · Misuse risk Abruptly yanking the conversation back, or using the return to pressure, expose

THE MOVE

Can I come back to the part about timing for a second? What makes that the hard bit? -> Before we leave it, you mentioned trust. Is that the main issue here? -> I do not want to lose the thread about your team. What changed there? -> Can we ?

START HERE

Notice the earlier open thread, then bridge back with one line: "Can I come back to the part about X for a second?"

SAY THIS

Quick returns	<i>"Can I come back to something you said earlier?"</i>
Name the thread and...	<i>"Can I come back to the part about timing? What makes that the hard bit?"</i>
Social versions	<i>"Wait, I want to come back to the part about the trip - what happened there?"</i>
Professional versions	<i>"Before we close this, can we return to the customer-impact point?"</i>
Digital / written versi...	<i>"Pulling one thread back up: you mentioned timing. Is that the main blocker?"</i>
Under pressure or in...	<i>"I know we are moving quickly. One thread we should not lose is this."</i>

AVOID

- The other person explicitly closed the topic or declined to discuss it.
- Returning would expose them in front of others.
- The current topic is urgent, time-sensitive, or emotionally more important.

REMEMBER

Return softly, not abruptly.